

## Gestures and movement

Gestures can make a presenter seem more enthusiastic and engaging. Speakers often wave their hands around to emphasize certain points and catch an audience's attention. Walking around a room makes a delivery more personal because the speaker moves closer to certain individuals. Making eye contact with individuals in an audience is also important.



- A speaker must sound **enthusiastic**. If he or she sounds bored, the audience will be, too.
- It can be useful to **practice** a speech in front of a **mirror**.



### △ Enthusiasm

Enthusiastic gestures, such as punching the air or waving, can make a speaker seem more passionate.



Maintain eye contact to engage the audience.

### △ Big ideas

Some actions—for example, spreading out the arms—can emphasize the size of an issue.

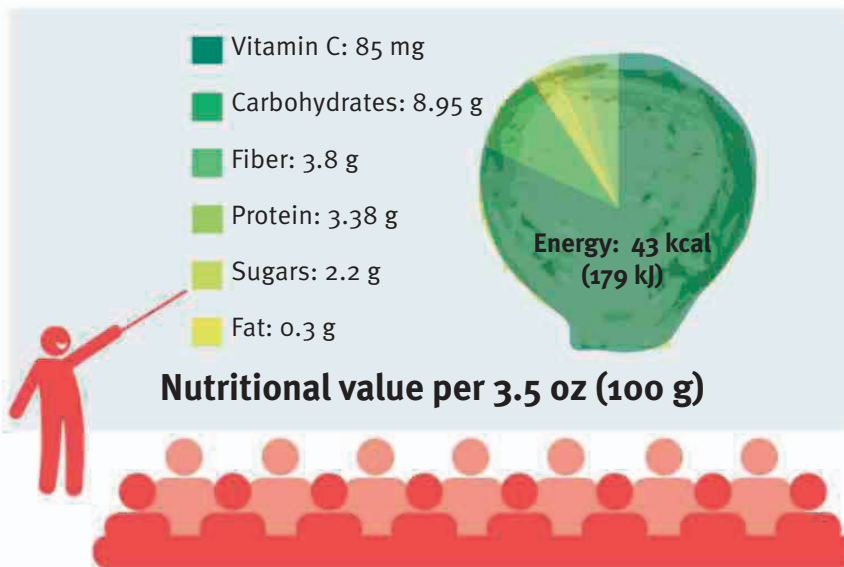


### △ Distraction

It's important not to move around too much. Awkward movements can distract an audience from what the speaker is saying.

## Visual aids

Sometimes speakers use visual aids to engage their audiences. These include images, graphs, and diagrams that explain complicated information or make it more interesting. Summarizing key points on a projector slide or handout will also emphasize the most important details, and help the audience to remember them.



### REAL WORLD

#### Dressing down

Public speakers even think about the way they dress when speaking to an audience. Some politicians or business professionals decide not to wear a suit and tie when making a speech to the public. By wearing more casual clothes, they hope that they will look more relaxed and approachable, so the audience will relate to them.

